

Friday, 25 September 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Overcast

24° 15°

BIRMINGHAM

Light drizzle

18° 13°

MANCHESTER

Drizzle

16° 12°

GLASGOW

Light rain

15° 12°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1 Crashed RAF jet steered to 'avoid built-up areas' before pilots ejected, commander says.

Gp Capt Gez Currie said the pilots are in hospital, and their families are with them.

UK · NEWS

2 NHS trust to review 4,500 more breast cancer cases after failings.

The BBC has spoken to women who suffered unnecessary surgery, delayed diagnoses and a lack of care.

UK · NEWS

3 Anti-migrant activist arrested after dinghy slashed in Channel.

Police had been looking into footage appearing to show the man, also known as Danny Tommo, slashing at a boat in the English Channel with a knife.

UK · NEWS

4 Greek PM urges Burnham to return Elgin Marbles permanently.

Andy Burnham said in 2023 the sculptures should be returned to Greece with "no strings attached".

UK · NEWS

5 Blood tests find high level of cancer-causing forever chemical in residents near factory.

People living near a major chemical factory in Lancashire are told they could be at risk of serious health conditions.

POLITICS · UK

02 — SHOWBIZ

What's coming up

- 1 Greek PM urges Burnham to return Elgin Marbles permanently.**
Andy Burnham said in 2023 the sculptures should be returned to Greece with "no strings attached".
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 2 Harry Potter play producer says cost of living made two-part show 'impossible'.**
The London production, which has been running for 10 years, will reopen next month as a one-part show.
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 3 Teen rocker Nene Royal becomes first Thai to win America's Got Talent.**
Her heavy metal performance trumped nine other finalists, including magicians and even a robot crew.
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 4 Federal judge delays ruling on White House media ban.**
During a roughly 45-minute hearing, a lawyer for CNN, Politico and MS NOW disputed Trump administration arguments that the ban was over national security concerns.
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 5 The chef turned award-winning author unfazed by 'second book syndrome'.**
Louise Kennedy, the author of Trespasses, says everyone "should give anything they fancy a lash".
SHOWBIZ · UK

On the schedule

1

Drinking at football matches - would fans welcome it?

Andy Burnham has long championed a repeal of the ban which prevents football supporters from drinking alcohol in the view of the pitch. But do fans even want it?

SPORT · UK

2

Fury v Joshua announced for 11 December in Cardiff.

Cardiff's Principality Stadium will host Anthony Joshua and Tyson Fury's all-British heavyweight fight on 11 December.

SPORT · UK

3

Ex-England striker Carroll reveals he was sexually assaulted in 2021.

Former England striker Andy Carroll reveals he was sexually assaulted in 2021, by a man who has subsequently been jailed for three years.

SPORT · UK

4

How Man City overhauled their squad from a 650,000-strong database.

BBC Sport goes inside Manchester City's data team, who have been a key part of their rebuild over the past 18 months.

SPORT · UK

5

McLaren miles off pace in Baku practice - Norris.

Lando Norris says McLaren were "miles off" the pace after the first day's practice at the Azerbaijan Grand Prix.

SPORT · UK

Quick hits

- 1 Local 'repair cafés', where volunteers fix broken items for free, are spreading across the UK.**
Toasters, lamps and zips are the most common patients. Organisers say the biggest barrier is convincing people their old kettle is worth saving.
- 2 Pubs report a Tuesday boom — the new 'mid-week meet' is the fastest-growing dining occasion.**
Operators say WFH-ers like getting out the house mid-week without the weekend crowds. Tuesday wine sales are up almost 30%.
- 3 Almost 70% of UK households now have a smart speaker — but the most common use is still 'asking what time it is'.**
Researchers say we under-use the devices we own. Setting timers, playing music and weather queries make up two thirds of all commands.
- 4 Holiday firms report a 40% spike in 'shoulder season' bookings — September and October sun trips are way up on last year.**
Travellers blame school-holiday flight prices, unreliable summer weather, and 'August feels too crowded these days'. Spain, Greece and Portugal top the wish list.
- 5 Three quarters of dog owners now talk to their dog more than they talk to their partner.**
Top topics: 'what we're doing later', 'what we just saw out the window' and a surprising amount of Bake Off commentary. 12% admit they've apologised to the dog after a row with the human.
- 6 Tinned fish is unexpectedly trendy again, with younger shoppers leading the charge.**
Sardines and mackerel are being repackaged as a quick, cheap protein. Older shoppers are quietly baffled, having eaten it for decades.
- 7 A study finds the average person has a 'comfort route' they walk or drive even when there's a faster way.**
Familiarity, not speed, wins. We'd rather the known road with the nice tree than save three minutes on the ring road.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

- Q** 62% of us have a particular **THIS** we refuse to throw away.
ANSWER: A BATTERED OLD HOODIE THAT'S BASICALLY HELD TOGETHER BY MEMORIES.
- Q** Asked what we'd grab first if we had ten seconds to leave the house, the top answer was **THIS**.
ANSWER: THE PHONE – OBVIOUSLY.

TALK TOPIC

- **Researchers reckon the perfect length for a nap is 26 minutes.**
Are you a napper or does it ruin your whole night? And what's the worst place you've ever fallen asleep?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

- FACT** **Animals.** Cows have best friends and can become stressed when separated from them. Studies have shown their heart rates rise when they're kept apart from a preferred companion.
- FICTION** **Made up, but believable.** A farm in Somerset has started playing the shipping forecast to its hens after the farmer became convinced it makes them lay rounder eggs.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£5.8 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£5.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The heart of a blue whale is so big a small child could theoretically crawl through its arteries.
- There are more public libraries than McDonald's restaurants in the UK.
- Goosebumps evolved to make our ancestors look bigger and to fluff up body hair for warmth.
- The Mona Lisa has no eyebrows.
- A 'baker's dozen' is 13 because medieval bakers added an extra loaf to avoid being fined for short measures.
- The fingerprints of a koala are so similar to a human's they could confuse a crime scene.
- The Eiffel Tower can be about 15cm taller in summer because the iron expands in heat.
- Pineapples take around two years to grow a single fruit.

On this day

Day 268 of the year, 97 days left in 2026. Today Armed Forces Day or Revolution Day (Mozambique); Bangladeshi Immigration Day (United States); Christian feast day: Abadir and Irajā and Companions (Coptic Church); Christian feast day: Aunarius (Aunacharius). Star sign Libra, birthstone Sapphire.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1943 — Robert Walden, American actor, director, and screenwriter
- 1964 — Maria Doyle Kennedy, Irish actress and singer
- 1976 — Santigold, American singer-songwriter and producer
- 1992 — Teddy Swims, American singer and songwriter
- 1981 — Lee Norris, American actor
- 1974 — Paul Hurst, English footballer and manager
- 2009 — Leah Jeffries, American actress
- 1997 — Antonia Gentry, American actress

THE DAY TODAY

- 1956 — TAT-1, the first submarine transatlantic telephone cable system, is inaugurated.
- 1969 — The charter establishing the Organisation of Islamic Cooperation is signed.
- 1974 — Dr. Frank Jobe performs first ulnar collateral ligament replacement surgery (better known as Tommy John surgery) on baseball player Tommy John.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1959 — S. W. R. D. Bandaranaike, Prime Minister of Ceylon, is mortally shot by a Buddhist monk, Talduwe Somarama, and dies the next day.
- 1918 — World War I: The end of the Battle of Megiddo, the climax of the British Army's Sinai and Palestine campaign under General Edmund Allenby.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1955 — The Royal Jordanian Air Force is founded.
- 1915 — World War I: The Second Battle of Champagne begins.

- 1983 — Thirty-eight IRA prisoners, armed with six handguns, hijack a prison meals lorry and smash their way out of the Maze Prison.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 269 of the year, 96 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast days: Canadian Martyrs (Catholic Church in Canada); Christian feast days: Cosmas and Damian; Christian feast days: Blessed Crescencia Valls Espí; Christian feast days: John of Meda. Star sign Libra, birthstone Sapphire.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1944 — Anne Robinson, English journalist and game show host
- 1960 — Doug Supernaw, American country music singer-songwriter and guitarist (died 2020)
- 1962 — Al Pitrelli, American guitarist and songwriter
- 1961 — Cindy Herron, American singer-songwriter and actress
- 1972 — Shawn Stockman, American singer
- 1973 — Chris Small, Scottish snooker player and coach
- 1991 — Dan Preston, English footballer
- 1969 — Paul Warhurst, English footballer and manager

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1978 — Air Caribbean Flight 309 crashes in Residencial Las Casas in San Juan, Puerto Rico, killing six.
- 2002 — The overcrowded Senegalese ferry, MV Le Joola, capsizes off the coast of the Gambia killing more than 1,000.
- 2010 — The Philippine Bar exam bombing occurs near the De La Salle University in Taft Avenue, Manila injuring 47 people.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1997 — An earthquake strikes the Italian regions of Umbria and the Marche, causing part of the Basilica of St. Francis at Assisi to collapse.
- 2002 — The overcrowded Senegalese ferry, MV Le Joola, capsizes off the coast of the Gambia killing more than 1,000.

Coming to cinemas

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 25 Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16 Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller

FRI 23 Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar